Paradise

John Prine (1971)

Key: D

(Verse 1)
When [D] I was a child my [G] family would [D] travel,
down to Western Kentucky where my [A7]parents were [D]born
And there's a backwards old town that's [G] often re [D] membered,
so many times that my [A7] memories are [D] worn.

(Chorus)
And [D] daddy won't you take me back to [G] Muhlenberg [D] County,
down by the Green River where [A7] Paradise [D] lay
Well, I'm sorry my son, but you're [G] too late in [D] asking,
Mr. Peabody's coal train has [A7] hauled it a [D] way

(Verse 2)
Well, sometimes we'd travel right [G] down the Green [D] River,
to the abandoned old prison down by [A7] Adrie [D] Hill
Where the air smelled like snakes and we'd [G] shoot with our [D] pistols,
but empty pop bottles was [A7] all we would [D] kill.

(Chorus)
And [D] daddy won't you take me back to [G] Muhlenberg [D] County,
down by the Green River where [A7] Paradise [D] lay
Well, I'm sorry my son, but you're [G] too late in [D] asking,
Mr. Peabody's coal train has [A7] hauled it a [D] way

(Guitar break)

When [D] I was a child my [G] family would [D] travel,
down to Western Kentucky where my [A7]parents were [D]born

(Verse 3)
Then the [D] coal company came with the [G] world's largest [D] shovel,
and they tortured the timber and [A7] stripped all the [D] land
Well, they dug for their coal till the [G] land was for [D] saken,

then they wrote it all down as the [A7] progress of [D] man.

(Chorus)
And [D] daddy won't you take me back to [G] Muhlenberg [D] County,
down by the Green River where [A7] Paradise [D] lay
Well, I'm sorry my son, but you're [G] too late in [D] asking,
Mr. Peabody's coal train has [A7] hauled it a [D] way

(Verse 4 - Instruments quieter)
When I [D] die let my ashes float [G] down the Green [D] River,
let my soul roll on up to the [A7] Rochester [D] dam
I'll be halfway to Heaven with [G] Paradise [D] waitin',
just five miles away from wher [A7] ever I [D] am.

(Chorus - Instruments normal)
And [D] daddy won't you take me back to [G] Muhlenberg [D] County,
down by the Green River where [A7] Paradise [D] lay
Well, I'm sorry my son, but you're [G] too late in [D] asking,
Mr. Peabody's coal train has [A7] hauled it a [D] way